

to say a class of row1, row2, row3 etc. There is a way for that as well: `table>tbody>tr.row$*3>td*5`. Here the “row\$” will become row1, row2, row3... If you have more than ten rows, you might want to write this as “row\$\$”, in which case the rows will be numbered row01, row02... You can use this trick in other places that use class as well.

Let's go up another step, we want to make a list where each entry contains an image and a link. Here is how you could do that: `ul>li*5>img+a`

The “+” here specifies that the image tag and the anchor tag are at the same level. Let's make this more complicated – cause we can – and have a sublist under each list, that has multiple links instead of just one: `ul>li*5>img+ul>li*5>a`

What if you wanted the list of links first, and then the image? You can't do: `ul>li*5>ul>li*5>a+img` because then the image will come under each sublist element instead of list element. Instead, you can use parenthesis to make your case clearer: `ul>li*5>(ul>li*5>a)+img`

Using parenthesis you can create astonishingly complex HTML code in just a single line. In fact, Zen Coding has a number of shortcuts for some complex bits of code. For example, if you want the basic boilerplate code to begin your HTML document, you don't even need to write it in Zen Code; all you need to do is expand “html:4t” to get the basic structure of an HTML 4 transitional DTD document. For HTML5 use “html:5” and you will have the basics, html, head, body all in a second. There are a number of such shortcuts in Zen Coding — that is after all what it's about — that you will find useful. Here are a few of them:

`link:css` expands to the standard code for attaching a stylesheet. `link:touch`, `link:atom`, `link:rss` and `link:favicon` expand to the code for the touch icon, the feeds, and the favicon.

`script` automatically adds the script type, while `script:src` also adds an src attribute

`input:text`, `input:checkbox`, `input:file` etc. expand to the standard code for the input elements.

`table+` expands to a table of a single row and column.

One final thing, before we move on to some of Zen Coding's other cool features. Till now all our examples might have a complex HTML structure, but they are missing the actual text content. There is a shortcut for that as well. If you want a paragraph with some text, you can do the following: `p>[Some text to feature inside a paragraph]`

And Zen Some More

Zen has a number of features in addition to expanding abbreviations; we won't cover all of them here. Two important and closely-related features are, jumping between edit points and the ability to wrap existing content in a tag.

If you just added a table, or a list of items, it is likely you want to start filling in after making the

*pointers

>>Nuggets of cool code at work



*Firefox 3D view

>>Helpful for debugging, the 3D view stacks elements as they are nested in the DOM and lets you see elements that are hidden or off the page. > 00:42

<http://dvw.x.in/apr-12-p1>



*When consoles die what comes next

>>Ben Cousins, General Manager of ngmoco() talks about the death of console gaming, and what the future could hold. > 25:54

<http://dvw.x.in/apr-12-p2>



*Introducing Adobe Shadow

>>Adobe's Charlie Scheinost gives a quick demonstration of Adobe Shadow, a handy new tool for mobile development. Duration > 46:22

<http://dvw.x.in/apr-12-p3>



*Inventor Portrait: Ralph Baer

>>Ralph Baer is often called the father of video games. His invention, the Magnavox Odyssey, was the first home console system. Here's an interview with Baer, which was shot as he turns 90, and still continues to invent. Duration > 03:15

<http://dvw.x.in/apr-12-p4>

structure. Zen Coding defines edit points for different kinds of content so you can jump between them and quickly add or edit content rather than manually go to each point using the keyboard or mouse. What this does is automatically move the cursor from inside one td element to another using shortcuts (usually Ctrl+Alt+Right or Ctrl+Alt+Left to move between edit points). For example, if you just added a table, you can jump from one td element to another; if you added a list you can jump from one list item to another; if you added an anchor tag, you can jump from the href attribute to the content of the anchor tag.

Now, if you want the some text to be wrapped inside a hierarchy of tags, you can use the shortcut key for wrapping instead of expanding, and enter the shorthand Zen code as usual. So if you were to select some text, and use the wrap hotkey, you could quickly have it embedded deep within a paragraph tag withing a div tag withing anther div tag, within an HTML body. You have all the power of Zen Coding, as described above, at your disposal here as well.

It gets even better though; if you have a list of items that you wish to enclose in a link, and you want each item to individually be linked to it's own page, Zen Coding can help you there as well. An example of this would be a site's navigation structure. You start with the following text:

- Home
- Category1
- Category2
- Blog
- About Us
- Contact

And want to wrap each inside an anchor tag in a list. As we said before, select this text, use the expand abbreviation hotkey and in the popup box, enter the following: `ul>li*>a`

Notice we haven't added a number after * because it can extrapolate the number of entries based on the lines of text, here five. When you are done, you will be left with:

```
<ul>
<li><a href="">Home</a></li>
<li><a href="">Category1</a></li>
<li><a href="">Category2</a></li>
<li><a href="">Blog</a></li>
<li><a href="">About Us</a></li>
<li><a href="">Contact</a></li>
</ul>
```

The hotkey is [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [A] in the online version, however this is also the shortcut for the add-ons page in Firefox, so you will have to close that after using the hotkey to get back to your page.

Zen Coding is an incredibly powerful tool at you disposal if you are a web developer, and one that can save a lot of the time you spend in coding. It doesn't matter which IDE you use, Zen Coding is the real time-saver when it comes to web coding. >